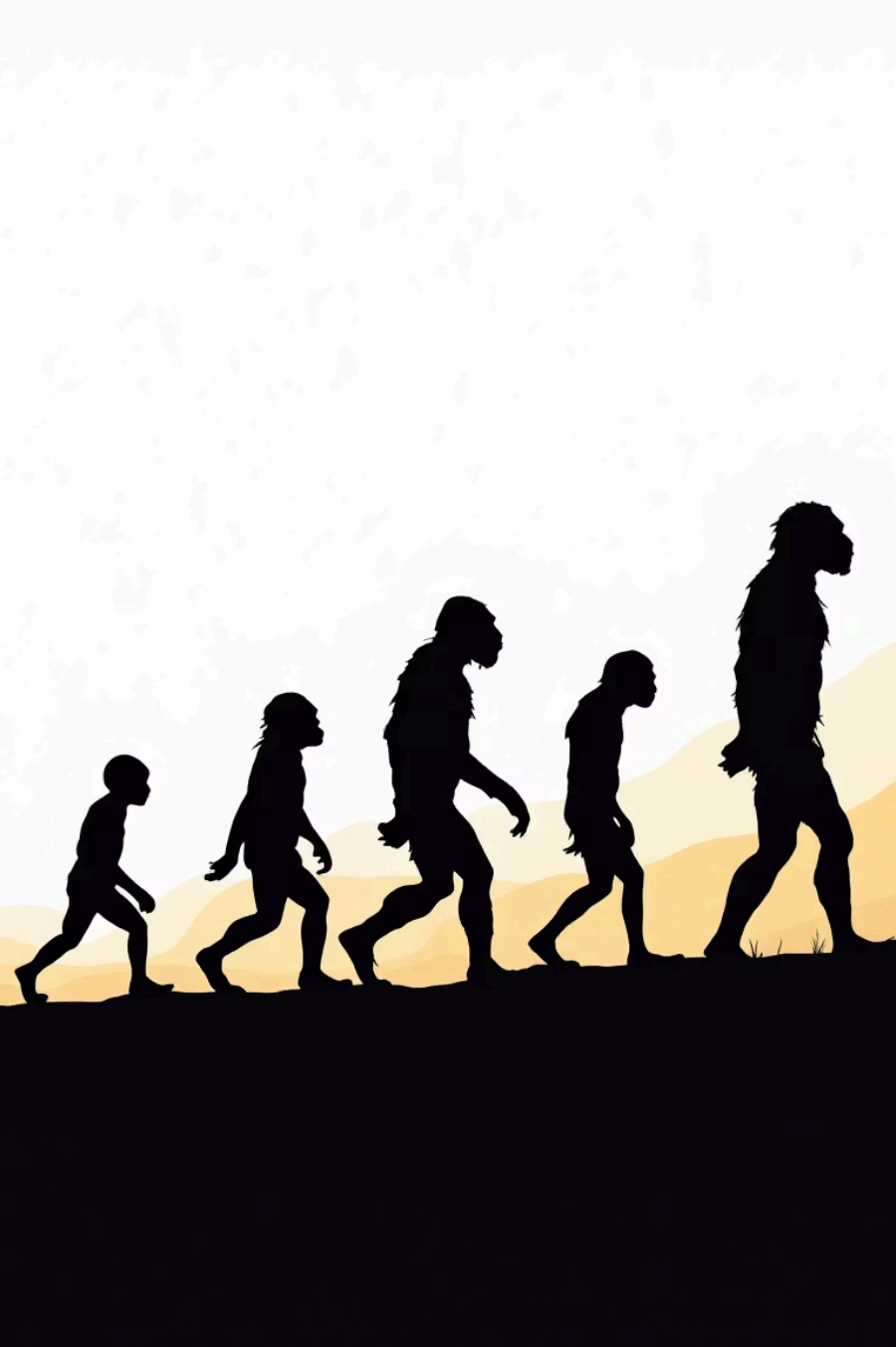
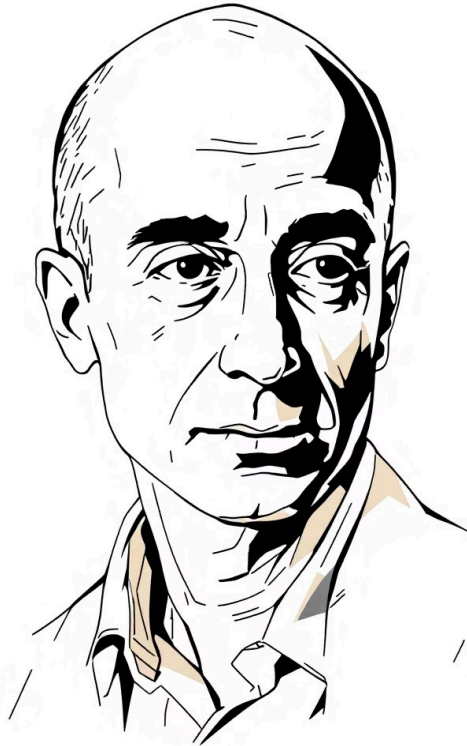




Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind

Key learnings and reflections on how we became who we are—and where we're going next.



Yuval Noah Harari: The Historian Philosopher

A leading voice in understanding humanity's past, present, and future.

- PhD in History from Oxford University
- Professor at Hebrew University of Jerusalem
- Author of global bestsellers including *Sapiens*, *Homo Deus*, and *21 Lessons for the 21st Century*
- Over 12 million copies sold in 60+ languages

His work explores the intersection of history, biology, and philosophy—challenging us to rethink what it means to be human.



Why Study History?

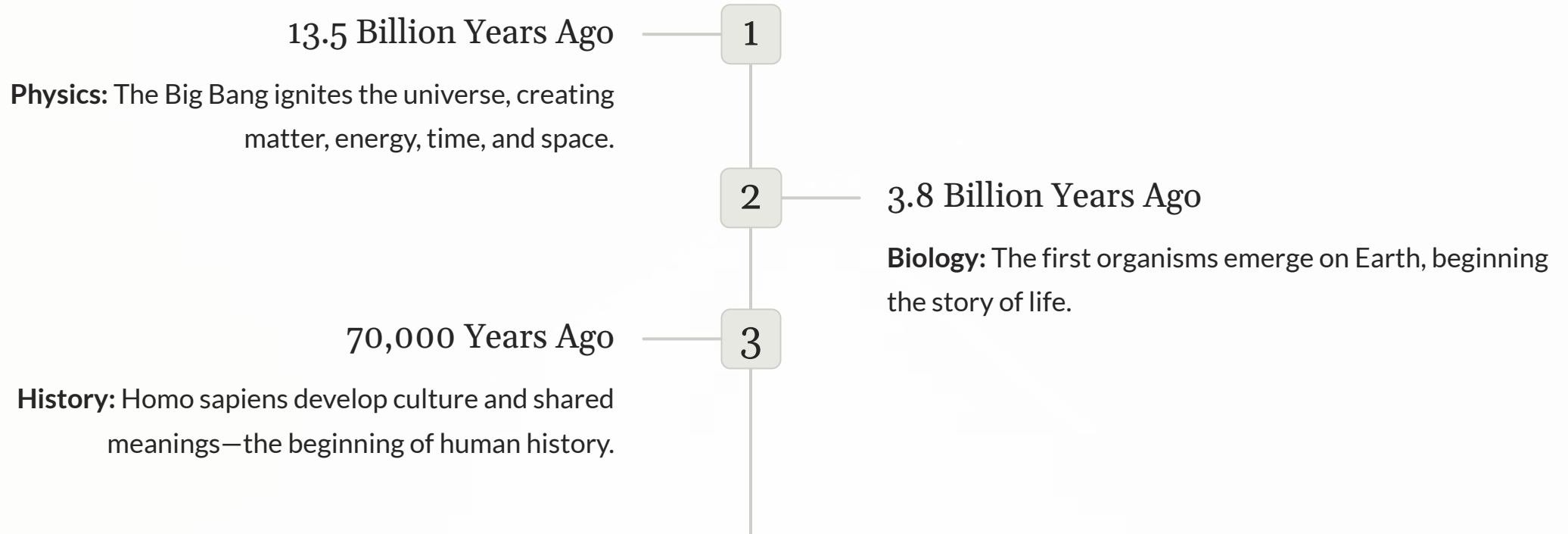
"We study history not to know the future but to widen our horizons."

— Yuval Noah Harari

History teaches us that our current world is neither natural nor inevitable. Everything we take for granted—nations, money, human rights—is a story we collectively created. By understanding this, we realize our power to shape new narratives and reimagine the future.

The Story of Everything

To understand humanity, we must first understand the timeline that led to us.



History begins when humans start creating shared stories and imagined realities that bind us together.



The Three Great Revolutions

Three pivotal moments transformed humanity and reshaped our world.



Cognitive Revolution

70,000 years ago

Humans developed imagination and language, enabling storytelling and large-scale cooperation through shared myths.



Agricultural Revolution

12,000 years ago

The shift from foraging to farming brought stability but also dependence, inequality, and harder labor.



Scientific Revolution

500 years ago

Curiosity and systematic experimentation unlocked technology and reshaped civilization at unprecedented speed.

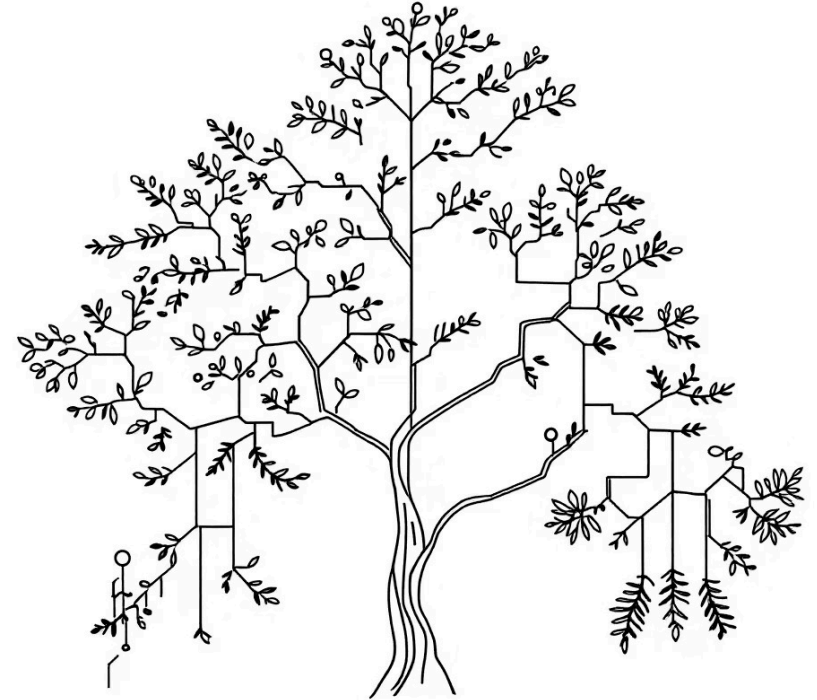
Homo Sapiens and the Family Tree

We Are Not Alone—We Were Never Meant to Be

Humans belong to the genus *Homo*, one of many species that walked the Earth. Just 100,000 years ago, six different human species coexisted.

- *Homo neanderthalensis* in Europe and Western Asia
- *Homo erectus* in East Asia
- *Homo soloensis* in Indonesia
- *Homo floresiensis* on isolated islands
- *Homo denisova* in Siberia
- *Homo sapiens* in East Africa

Only *Homo sapiens* survived—not through strength alone, but through our unique ability to cooperate in large numbers based on shared stories and myths.



FAMILY TREE



The Cognitive Revolution: The Power of Fiction

What made *Homo sapiens* different? We evolved language not just to describe reality—but to **create imagined realities**.

Shared Myths

Stories about gods, nations, and justice allowed strangers to cooperate in groups of thousands and millions.

Flexible Cooperation

Unlike other species bound by biology, humans can rapidly change behavior by updating our shared stories.

The Birth of Culture

Religion, laws, corporations, money—all are fictions that exist only in our collective imagination.

This cognitive leap transformed us from just another animal into the dominant species on Earth.

The Agricultural Revolution: History's Biggest Fraud?



Before: Freedom and Variety

- Foragers ate 100+ types of food
- Worked fewer hours per day
- Healthier, more varied diets
- Freedom of movement



After: Stability but Sacrifice

- Farmers depended on few crops
- Longer, harder working days
- Malnutrition and disease increased
- Tied to land and property

"The average farmer worked harder than the forager and got a worse diet in return. The Agricultural Revolution was history's biggest fraud."

We gained stability and larger populations—but lost freedom, health, and leisure. A trade-off we still live with today.

The Scientific Revolution: Embracing Ignorance

Around 500 years ago, humanity began a radical new chapter. Unlike previous eras defined by the belief in absolute truths, the Scientific Revolution was born from a profound admission of **ignorance**.

This acceptance of "we don't know" fueled an insatiable drive to observe, experiment, and discover, giving rise to the scientific method.

Science

Systematic observation & experimentation.



Empire

Global exploration & resource acquisition.

Capitalism

Funding & incentives for innovation.

This powerful marriage accelerated technological advancement, global exploration, and economic growth, setting humanity on an entirely new, and continually accelerating, trajectory.



The Stories We Live By Today

Harari's greatest lesson: We are a storytelling species. Our power lies in imagination—but we must remember that the stories shaping our world are just that: **stories**.



Admit Ignorance

True intelligence begins when we say "we don't know" and stay curious.



Question Our Myths

Money, nations, corporations—all imagined orders. Question them to create better ones.



Balance Progress with Purpose

Technology is powerful, but meaning comes from wisdom and conscious choice.

"When we break our prison walls and run towards freedom, we are in fact running into a more spacious yard of a bigger prison."

The journey of *Sapiens* continues—in how we choose to live, think, and imagine the future. What stories will we tell next?